noun plurals	*verb -s forms*
bus → buses	*cross → crosses*
church → churches	*fetch → fetches*

If a word ends in an -e, we add a n -s:

base → bases	*face → faces*
judge → judges	*lose → loses*

If the word ends in a consonant plus -y, we change -y to i and add -es:

noun plurals	*verb -s forms*
baby → babies	*marry → marries*
opportunity → opportunities	*reply → replies*

We add -esto some wor ds ending in -o:

noun plurals	*noun plurals/ verb -s forms*
tomato → tomatoes	*echo → echoes*

However, some words ending in -o only require -s: videos, discos, pianos, memos, photos.

For some nouns ending in -f or -fe, we form the plural by changing the -f or -fe to -ves:

loaf → loaves	shelf → shelves
thief → thieves	wife → wives

Spelling: doubling consonants(tense)

We often double the final consonant of a word (b, d, g, l, m, n, p, r, t) when a suffix beginning with a vowel is added (-ed, -er, -est, -ing):

hop + -ed → hopped	*slim + -ing → slimming*
red + -ish → reddish	*thin + -er → thinner*
rub + -ed → rubbed	*travel+ -er → traveller*
sit + -ing → sitting	*wet + -er → wetter*

When we add a suffix to a word with more than one syllable, we double the consonant only when the word ends in a stressed syllable:

admit + -ing → admitting	prefer + -ed → preferred
forget + -ing → forgetting	transmit + -ed → transmitted
occur + -ence → occurrence	upset + -ing → upsetting

Compare, visit or enter where the spoken stress is on the first syllable:

visit → visiting	*enter → entered*

Spelling: dropping and adding letters

The final -e (Noun formation)

We often drop the final -e when a suffix beginning with a vowel is added to a word:

approve + -al → approval	*hope + -ing → hoping*
fame + -ous →famous	*invite + -ation → invitation*
hate + -ed → hated	*note + -able → notable*
argue → argument	*true → truly*
due → duly	*whole → wholly*

Changing -y to -i

When we add a suffix to a word ending in a consonant + -y, we normally change -y to i:

amplify + -er → amplifier	*fury + -ous → furious*
busy + -ness → business	*purify + -cation → purification*
day + -ly → daily	*reply + -ed → replied*

Unit-6_109-125_SPARE A THOUGHT - March-11-2018.indd 112 21-01-2019 10:38:29